

Rep. Marjorie Taylor Greene blasts Trump’s Epstein focus

In an interview, Greene said if Republicans don’t pivot to affordability quickly, the midterm elections are Democrats’ to win.



Rep. Marjorie Taylor Greene (R-Ga.) is seen at the U.S. Capitol on July 23, 2025. | Francis Chung/POLITICO

By **ALEX GANGITANO**
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Donald Trump says Marjorie Taylor Greene has lost her way.

Greene disagrees.

The Republican firebrand, once one of the president’s strongest Capitol Hill allies, says it’s the president who is off course. He shouldn’t be trying to stop the release of the Epstein files, when so many of his most ardent followers are struggling to pay the bills.

“It’s insanely the wrong direction to go,” Greene told POLITICO. “The five-alarm fire is health care and affordability for Americans. And that’s where the focus should be.”

As the Trump administration struggles with how to respond to voters’ worries around rising prices, Greene is banging the drum that the Republican Party needs to be laser focused on the economy instead of getting sidetracked, in her eyes, by foreign crises and trying to block the release of documents related to the late convicted sex offender Jeffrey Epstein.

The Georgia Republican, who has become a rare Trump critic within the GOP, has grown increasingly critical of how the president is handling the issue of affordability, issuing a warning ahead of 2026:

“This is me wanting my party to do something, to win and do something good for the American people. It’s not me going against, it’s me pushing my party to say, this is what we need to be doing,” Greene said. “Not only is it the right thing to do for America, but if you want to win the midterms, this is what we need to be doing, deliver for Americans if we want them to send us back in 2026.”

Greene’s remarks come after [CNN reported Wednesday](#) that Trump administration officials called Rep. Lauren Boebert (R-Colo.) to the White House Situation Room to discuss her signature on the discharge petition forcing the Justice Department to release the Epstein files. Trump [reportedly tried to reach out to](#) Rep. Nancy Mace (R-S.C.), another signatory. Greene is the third Republican who signed Rep. Thomas Massie’s (R-Ky.) discharge petition, which now has the 218 required signatures to move forward and is expected to [come to the House floor for a vote](#) next week.

“Releasing the Epstein files is the easiest thing in the world,” she said. “Just release it all, let the American people sort through every bit of it, and, you know, support the victims. That’s just like the most common sense, easiest thing in the world. But to spend any effort trying to stop it makes — it just doesn’t make sense to me.”

A White House official bashed Greene’s criticism over the Epstein discharge petition effort and minimizing affordability concerns.

“Complaining about a lack of focus on healthcare affordability while actively working to advance a gigantic Democrat distraction that has nothing to do with bettering the lives of everyday Americans is an unusual choice,” spokesperson Abigail Jackson said. “The White House is focusing on lowering costs for all Americans, and is eager to work with both parties in order to advance legislative priorities to address these issues.”

Trump on Monday was [dismissive of Greene’s recent suggestion](#) that there should be [nonstop meetings at the White House](#) on domestic policy and not foreign policy.

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“I don’t know what happened to Marjorie,” he told reporters. “Nice woman. But I don’t know what happened, she’s lost her way, I think.”

In an interview Thursday, Greene wouldn’t discuss whether the president has made any effort to patch up their relationship. She confirmed that the White House didn’t reach out to her about taking her name off the discharge petition on Wednesday like they did, unsuccessfully, with Mace and Boebert.

Trump publicly warned all Republicans against working with Democrats to force a vote in the House on releasing the Epstein files.

“Only a very bad, or stupid, Republican would fall into that trap,” Trump said [on Truth Social](#). “There should be no deflections to Epstein or anything else, and any Republicans involved should be focused only on opening up our Country, and fixing the massive damage caused by the Democrats!”

The falling out between Trump and Greene comes as the Republican Party is trying to figure out its identity after the president leaves office.

Greene has called out Trump for not being focused on an America First agenda — the main pillar of the MAGA movement. She has criticized the administration for ignoring the high cost of living and focusing instead on foreign policy, while Trump has repeatedly bragged that among his biggest achievements in his second term has been ending multiple wars abroad.

She blamed last week’s bruising elections for Republicans [on her party disenfranchising](#) the America First agenda and [she said she was against](#) “bringing any foreign leader that is a terrorist or oversees killing

innocent people into our country and into the Oval Office” after Trump took office in January 2017.



“I’m just speaking for myself, I’m America first. I am 100 percent for my country, no other country,” Greene told POLITICO. “That’s what a lot of people thought they voted for in 2024. ... It’s a failure of our Republican majority in the House and the Republican majority in the Senate, if we aren’t legislating that way and making that happen.”

Greene said that if she had to call the midterms today, Democrats would win.

“I don’t see how we win the midterms on the course that we’ve been set on so far,” she said.

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